

Term Paper

Body Paragraph 3

Excerpt A:

Makes villains or criminals look smart and powerful, which kids follow and admire
Indian OTT Platforms and a Study on the Role of Antagonist in Psycho-Thriller Web Series.
Shabnam Shahin, Dr. M Nawaz Khan, & Shriprakash Pal
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theasianthinker.com

Asur (Voot): It is a thriller web series that inclines dominantly towards the mythological history of the streets of Benaras and how it gets connection with a modern-day criminal named Asur. The plot involves Nikhil Nair, a forensic-expert-turned-teacher, who returns to his roots in the CBI getting into the investigation of a mysterious and suspense-filled chase against the serial killer 'Asur'. Nikhil Nair along with his mentor Dhananjay Rajpoot faces all events in the web series to unravel the true identity of the killer, who challenges them in every way possible. One of the most intriguing yet sinister villains on OTT platform is Shubh Joshi from Asur, portrayed by Vishesh Bansal (as the teenage boy) and Amey Wagh (as the adult), who according to his father for being born in a Asur nakshatra has to suffer from traumatic childhood and that led him to channelize his talent towards negativity and started believing that he is an avatar of Asur Kali¹. According to him when this world will be full of misdeeds and bad people and when there will be no humanity left only then Kalki² will be born and he wanted to challenge Kalki. He ardently believed that Asurs always were the victims of injustice.

Anti-heroes or negative icons are highly glorified on the OTT platform, making deep influences on the youth's behavior. Characters like villains, and criminals are sometimes given prominent role, with which youths can relate. At some points they become aspiration for them. Their intelligent, charming, commanding things cover the lines of morality for viewers. For instance, studies indicate that most OTT platforms have made the villain intelligent and powerful. From Shubh Joshi in Asur to Hathoda Tyagi in Paatal Lok, characters are thrown up as if criminality has become aspirational for the youth.

The trend makes certain behavior which normally are violative and manipulative look like cool and worth following. Such portrayals result in deletion of youth's no longer having the ability to distinguish between right and wrong, they imitate these characters and relate them in social behaviors and in decisions making. The negative influence of such role models is enhanced because OTT platforms make such content freely available without any restrictions.

Paatal Lok (Amazon Prime Video): It is a crime thriller series where a lower ranking cop lands the case of a lifetime when four suspects are nabbed in the assassination attempt of a prime-time journalist. The case turns out to be a devious maze where nothing is what it looks like. The pursuit of it leads him to the dark netherworld- the "Paatal Lok", and to shocking discoveries in the past of the four suspects. Hathoda Tyagi portrayed by Abhishek Banerjee, who after leaving his mark with his amazing comic roles in Bollywood

films has brought a whole new character in Amazon Prime Video's psycho-thriller web series 'Paatal Lok'. Hathoda Tyagi was a divisive character, on one hand he was a sinister hammer-wielding killer who showcased the characteristics of a villain but on the other hand, his motivations of doing such deeds made the audience empathise with his character. He portrayed a dark character which was not any usual character to be seen on screen, Hathoda Tyagi managed to send chills down the spine making the audience shiver in all the freakish ways.

Excerpt B:

Youngers start to practice ill behaviour and get involved in crimes

The Discretion of OTT Platform- Impact on Youth In The Light Of Censorship

Asst.Prof.Varsha Badwe & Mr. Akshay Nesrikar

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210.212.169.38/xmlui/bitstream/handle/123456789/10167/The%20Discretion%20of%20OTT%20Platform%20Impact%20on%20Youth%20In%20The%20Light%20Of%20Censorship%20Varsha%20Badwe%20c%20Akshay%20Nesrikar.pdf?sequence=1&isAllowed=y

Generally, it is observed that youths are more likely to follow one's behaviour as they can easily relate to such characters displayed on these OTT platforms. Also, it is the main cause of behavioural changes found in the youth recently. Apart from such developments in the behavioural patterns within the youth it also has following reverberations:

- Lack of socialisation in youth.
- Cases of insomnia, depression, obesity, and ailments related to eyes have increased amongst the younger generations.
- Youth have been lacking in their academic career as a result of lack of attention towards their studies.
- These web shows are also known to promote drinking alcohol, doing drugs and weed without mentioning their long term effects on one's health.

The normalization of the worst behaviors, and in some cases, celebrating them happen because the youth's consumption of these unethical manipulative, aggressive, and crime glorified contents. Moreover, real-life incidents also point to this effect of such portrayal. The case of Nikita Tomar's murder at the hands of Tausif, who claimed to have been inspired by Munna Bhai of Mirzapur. This revealed how fictional characters are influencing the vulnerable to dangerous behavior.

The above incident underlines the dire need for regulatory mechanisms so that such tragic consequences could be avoided. The trend of negative role modeling, which is getting glamorized through OTT platforms making the youths think that this is what normal is, even the heinous crimes. To sum up, the glorification of these rouge characters done by

OTT platforms are destroying the mindset of youngsters and inspiring them in doing awful things.

Recently, a B.Com third year student was murdered while she was returning home after the exam, a boy named, Tausif, had shot her. Tausif had one sided love with Nikita and he had planned the killing after he had watched the web series Mirzapur wherein a character named Munna Bhaiya kills a character, Sweetie, in a case of one-sided love story, which he confessed in the police custody. Hence, Tausif got influenced by this story, he waited for Nikita outside the college. As soon as Nikita came out of the college, Tausif began to force her into a car but she refused and protested against these actions of Tausif. As a result of which Tausif got agitated and shot her. This information about Tausif's confession is available on the digital platform of the reputed news channel. (Nikita Tomar murder accused was inspired by Munna from 'Mirzapur' web series: Report)